

Lost Voices

Game Design Document

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REVISION LIST

Revision Date	Version number
10/04/2024	1.0 [Creation]
10/24/2024	1.1 : Added Enemy Feature, Removed Passkey and replaced with Keycards,

1. INTRODUCTION

This document will describe the full design of the gameplay, features and art direction of the video game “Lost Voices”. This design document is a manifestation of the concluded ideas at the time period of 10/04/2024 to 10/07/2024. Revisions may apply overtime.

1.1 Genre

This section will describe the exact genre of the designated game “Lost Voices”. This section will also describe sub-genres that can be found within the game.

The following are the genre considered to be the appropriate listing for “Lost Voices”

- Puzzle
- Mystery
- Horror

1.2 Target Audience

The target audience for “Lost Voices” are those above 18 years of age as the game contains disturbing content and violent content and language.

1.3 Target Platform

The required machine to run “Lost Voices” is a PC

1.4 Development Software and Tools

The following is the software to be used for the development of “Lost Voices”.

Game Engine

- Unity3D

Audio

- Audacity for multitrack mixing and converting
- Bandlab
- Cakewalk Next
- Some Ambience or Sound effects from online websites (Free and Bought)

Art

- MedibangPaintPro [2D]
- Blender [3D]

- Bought Assets - Itch or other websites

2. CONCEPT

This section of the document will explain the main gameplay and mechanics of the game.

2.1 Overview

“Lost Voices” is a first person horror action-adventure game that contains puzzles that the player has to resolve. The player also has to manage machines that keep the space station running.

2.2 Inspiration

“Resident Evil 7 Biohazard and 8 Village”





"SOMA"



"Visage"



2.3 Core Gameplay

The core gameplay of "Lost Voices" is the exploration of a space station that contains multiple sections. Some sections are blocked if the player has not completed the requirements to unlock that section. Multiple puzzles can be found in the game that will challenge the player's ability to understand their surroundings.

2.3.1 Primary Mechanics and Features [MVP]

The game takes inspiration from Resident Evil's puzzle solving mechanics. This section explains the main mechanics that will be found within the game in numerous amounts and or the main mechanics of the game used by the player to progress through the game.

2.3.1.1 Puzzles

Keycards - Around the map keycards can be found to access multiple types of doors.

Item Puzzle - The player can find objects around the map that can unlock doors

2.3.1.2 Exploration

Space Station (Blocked off Sections)- the station is large enough to explore, most important areas needed are blocked off, allowing the player to feel a sense of progression when unlocking them.

Space Station (Free Roam) - Even without unlocking the blocked off areas, the player is given enough sections within the station to feel a sense of freedom to explore.

2.3.1.3 Hide

A creature dubbed the “Entity” will show itself from time to time, during these moments, the player must find a place to hide in and prevent getting caught and killed.

2.3.1.4 Motion Detector

The creature/ enemy can be detected using a motion sensor. Which can be utilized to inform the player whether the enemy is close to them or not.

2.3.2 Secondary Mechanics and Features

This section explains the mechanics that help the player progress through the game but not necessarily needed to progress the game if ignored.

2.3.2.1 Information Board

Whenever the player discovers something new it will be written in their Information Board which can be seen inside the main section the player spawns in.

Information that will be put in the board will be locations of items, lore and clues.

2.3.3 Resources

This section has all the resources the player will be using throughout the game, some of these are important resources that the player are required to keep watch.

Flashlight Battery - The flashlight the player is given has a limited amount of battery life, it can be recharged by collecting batteries found around the game, take note that the amount of batteries found around the game is limited.

Oxygen - The player has to manage their oxygen tank which acts as their health as well, refilling them at oxygen stations and areas filled with oxygen. Oxygen will be reduced when entering areas that lack oxygen and or if they take damage.

Motion Detector - is a tool that the player can use to detect any moving creature within a limited radius, it can detect through ventilation shafts and walls, useful in hunting rats and other creatures.

Hiding Spots - can be done from under a desk, empty lockers or ventilation.

2.3.4 Losing

The following are the possible ways the player can lose.

Death - death is one of the main reasons the player can lose, death can be accomplished in the following ways.

- Death by oxygen loss - some areas are oxygen deprived and will reduce the player's oxygen tank, once the oxygen tank is reduced to zero, they die
- Death to electrocution - some areas have exposed power lines, touching these powerlines causes the player to take damage and or killing them outright.
- Death due to the "Entity" - the entity is an invisible creature within the station hunting any living creature inside it. The player does not take oxygen damage, rather they are killed instantly if they are caught by the entity.

2.4 Setting

The theme of the game is horror sci-fi. The game is set inside an abandoned space station owned by a mega corporation.

Overtime as the player progresses the player will get to a more grimdark reality of the station similar to the video game SOMA

3. PLAYER EXPERIENCE

This section explains the gameplay mechanics, and features as well as how the player progresses through the game.

3.1 Objective

The player is required to explore the station until the end without allowing the station to degrade and explode. The player will be given a primary objective straight from the beginning, telling them to maintain the station in good capacity while trying to discover what had happened to the station.

Additionally after a certain amount of tasks the player will have to hide and run away from an enemy that will try to hunt them down.

3.2 Progressions

Sections around the station are closed off, and unlocking them gives the player additional areas to explore. Some areas give the player more items or new items.

3.3 User Interface

There will be a minimalistic approach to the User interface, the primary things in the interface will be the oxygen meter and flashlight battery.

3.3.1 Popup

A "press E to interact" pop up will appear whenever the user is hovering over an object they can interact with.

Tutorial popup may appear whenever the user first plays the game.
There will be an inventory popup whenever the player presses the tab button.
There will be a setting popup whenever the user presses the escape button.

4. NARRATIVE

This section explains the narrative story of the game, this includes world building and the level design of the game.

4.1 World Building

A mega corporation named "Victory Entertainment" has built multiple space stations around the galaxy, serving as exclusive entertainment zones filled with luxurious commodities for the rich folks of the galaxy. One of these stations is located at primera B, a single star system with 2 planets orbiting around it. The station was half built when it opened and sections were blocked off. Unknown to Victory Entertainment, a large unknown object was flying straight to the station. When it crashed, it ripped off a portion of the station that kept the life support systems running, due to this the guests were evacuated and the station was never reopened again for many years. Until recently of course, "Victory Entertainment" gave multiple contracts to different folks on fixing the station up, but the station was unfixable according to them. "Victory Entertainment" still wants to fix the station, so they hired a single Station Engineer to go to the station and help the other crew, assess the damages from inside and discover whatever is happening.

4.2 Story

You play as Peter Müller, a long time private station engineer sent to an abandoned station by a mega corporation to discover its faults. They tell you that the station has been abandoned for years due to mild complications within the station and you will be assessing damages and finding solutions on how to fix it alongside the other crew and engineers.

When you arrive you are greeted by the station with a large neon welcome sign inside a large entrance hall. You discover that everything is well kept, although some sections are locked.

You get in contact with Winston, one of the engineers sent to repair the station, he gives you a gist of what has been going on, and asks you to leave while you still can. You tell him that you can't since the transport was a one way travel to the station.

4.3 Characters

Peter Muller - The Main Character of the story, He is a Space Station Engineer hired by Victory Entertainment to assess the conditions of one of their Entertainment Space Station.

Winston - One of the Station Engineers tasked with repairing the station, however he is currently hiding inside the Right 1st Floor Utility Room, and has been hiding there since the “Creature” attacked the others.

5. ART, SOUND AND MUSIC

This section explains the artistic designs of “Lost Voices”, it goes through the inspirations and design choices for the game.

5.1 Art Interpretation and Design

The artistic design of “Lost Voices” is 3d lowpoly, similar to the game astroneer or lower poly like arctic eggs..

The atmospheric colors are dark tones to give a depressing vibe to the game. Trying to gain the same aesthetic and atmosphere of SOMA but in space.

Additionally, some 2d aspects of the game will have a pixel art design to them.

5.2 Sound Effects

Sound effects will be a major part of the game as this is one of the main ways the player will be given information from (audio cues). From air ventilation shafts emitting high pressure gas, to electrocuted water, sound effects will be a majority of the sounds found in “Lost Voices”

5.3 Music

Although minimal, the inspiration for the music of “lost voices” will be a darker tone and mood of the soundtrack of Outer Wilds or ost’s similar to Crow Country.



6. COMPETITION

Other much more complex games exist as competition for “Lost Voices”, games that were used as inspiration for “Lost Voices” are the primary competition of the game, but “Lost Voices” is not meant to replace or beat the existing competition but rather to maintain its existence in its genre.

“RESIDENT EVIL 7”

January 24 2017

\$12m+ in sales

Capcom

Enter the world of resident evil and play as Ethan Winters as he searches for his long missing wife in a derelict plantation occupied by an infected family, solving puzzles and fighting enemies.



“RESIDENT EVIL 8”

May 7th 2021

\$9m+ in sales

Capcom

Play as Ethan Winters once more who tries to search for his kidnapped daughter in a village filled with mutated creatures.



7. MONETIZATION

“Lost Voices” will primarily gain profit from game purchases and future DLC purchases.

7.1 Expansions

Future expansions that will be available would be additional stories with new mechanics that were not included in the base game.